

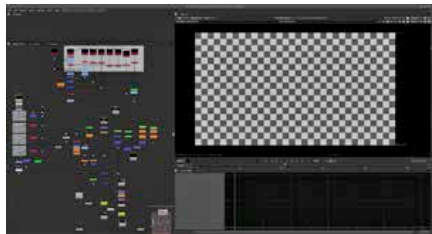
4) AUTODESK SMOKE

Just like Apple Motion, Autodesk Smoke is available exclusively on Mac and it's extremely powerful. Focusing on professional studios and individuals, it utilises combined editing workflows to facilitate increased productivity. In line with Apple and Adobe having 2 different software each for editing and visual effects, Autodesk is compatible with Final Cut Pro X (FCP X).

It's track based and has a non-linear editor workflow. The only drawbacks are the price which is a mammoth \$1620 per year or \$205 per month and that it uses a ton of RAM and has certain incomplete rendering functions. This for one is not for casual users!

5) NUKE

Another heavy duty software, Nuke is pretty popular in the film industry. It has hits sister apps in NukeX and Nuke Studio. Some amazing effects can be created with Nuke. Interestingly Nuke is available on Linux, Windows and Mac OS. Being a heavy-duty software, it comes with a heavy-duty price tag as well but it's also flexible in terms of how the software can be bought with monthly and annual subscription based models as well buying the whole software in one go.



A screen grab of Nuke in action. Clearly visible here is how the layout and workflow looks quite different from the previous softwares in question.

Compositing, creating special effects, building scripts with node based interfaces and numerous toolkits which are easily accessible are some of the focal points of Nuke. These can speed things up quite a bit. Batch edits to compositing in the node interface make reusability of scripts a piece of cake.

Elastic in its usability, Nuke is completely customisable enabling full workspace flexibility to suit your workflow and your own unique style. It promises absolute retention of quality in terms of colour, thereby taking common problems like colour shifting and quality loss off the table. What you put in is what you get out of it without any compromises. **d**